Comparing UMass Amherst Alcohol Use to Broader Collegiate Drinking: an AUDIT-Based Analysis Using R

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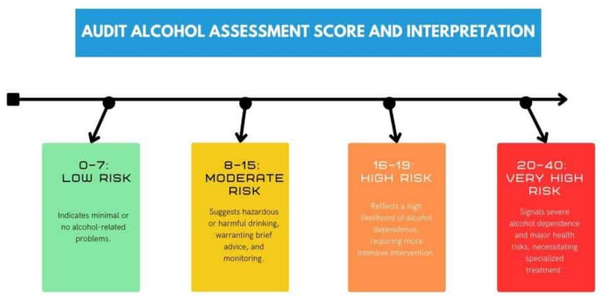
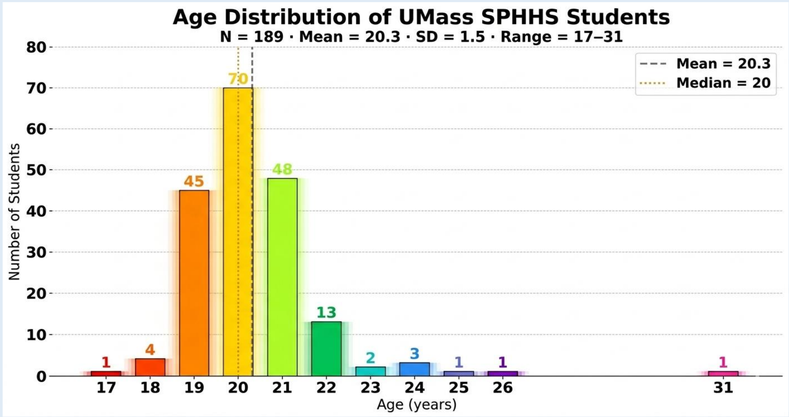
Introduction

- High-Risk alcohol consumption remains a critical public health concern driven by surrounding social dynamics and drinking culture
- National college-student survey data: 73.1% reported past-year alcohol use; 39.6% binge drank
- Goal to investigate whether SPHHS students apply their informed knowledge to their own behaviors and choices

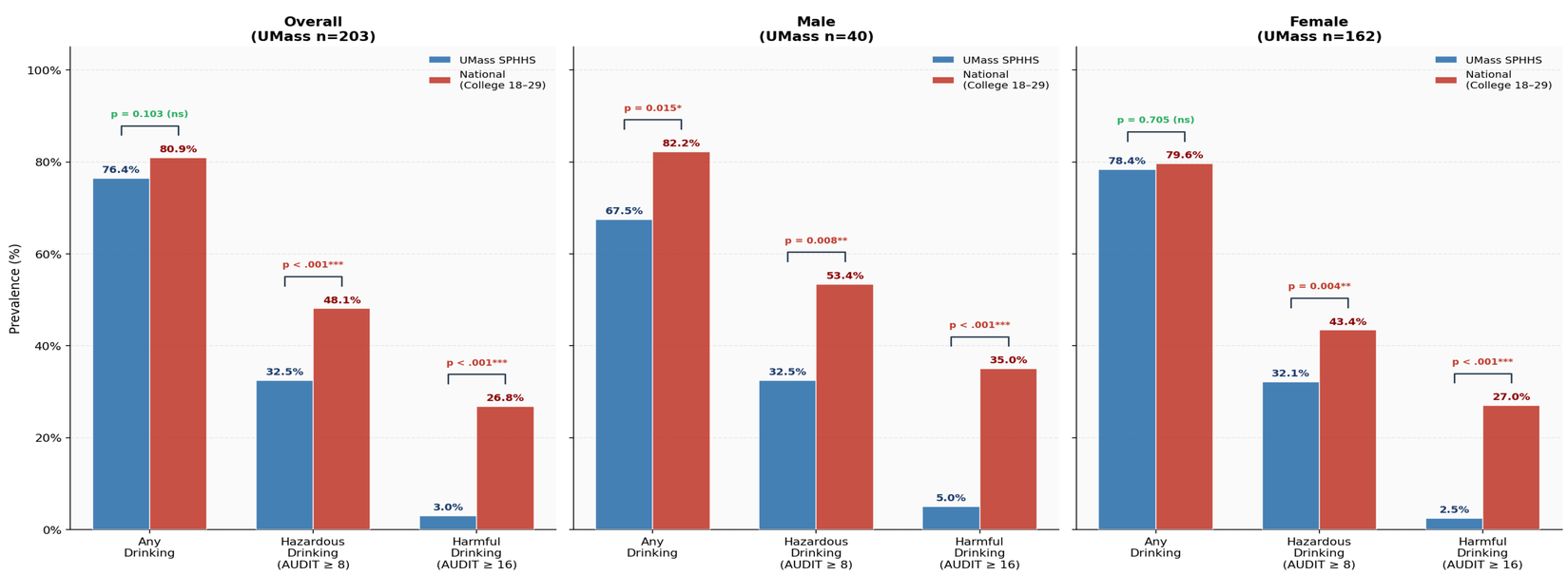
Methods

- Cross-sectional study conducted during the Fall 2025 semester
- Students at UMass Amherst were asked to complete an anonymous Google Forms Survey
- Population 203: Undergraduate and Graduate students, majority SPHHS
- Survey items based on Alcohol Screening Questionnaire (AUDIT)
  - Items included the frequency and severity of alcohol use and possible consequences experienced





Results



Discussion

- SPHHS sample shown to have less frequencies of "any drinking", "hazardous drinking", and "harmful drinking" vs. national data
  - Greater **female** % in "any drinking" category than male counterparts
- Although clinically & statistically significant, we would need to collect more data to ensure validity
- **Implications:** Public health education may help reduce drinking rates in college students

Limitations:

- **Self-reported:** Participants may not be able to recall past habits accurately
  - Survey conducted during a course project; students may underreport their habits
  - Many students are under the age of 21; may not have reported habits accurately
- **Small sample size may not be representative of the broader PH student population**